

Jordan Cooper

Engineering Leader | AI Agents | Backend & Platform Engineering

London Area, UK | Open to Remote & Hybrid Opportunities

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Summary

Engineering leader with 10+ years of experience building backend platforms, customer-facing products and engineering teams across fintech, payments and AI.

Most recently Head of Engineering at Zumi, joining as employee #1 to build the engineering organisation from the ground up whilst remaining hands-on with architecture and delivery. Led production AI work spanning agents, custom Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers, secure user-scoped API integrations and multi-tenant SaaS platforms.

Previously at Moneyhub, I built Open Banking APIs and payment products used by more than 1.6 million UK consumers, progressing through Software Engineer, Tech Lead, Engineering Manager and Solutions Architect roles.

I enjoy building high-performing teams, staying close to the technology and developing reliable platforms that balance product delivery, long-term engineering investment and enterprise trust.

Selected Achievements

- Built and led Zumi's engineering organisation from scratch, growing it to 10 engineers and contractors and establishing hiring, coaching, delivery, security and engineering standards.
- Designed reliable production AI capabilities including agents, custom MCP servers, secure user-scoped API access, evaluation frameworks and observability.
- Designed backend services and distributed systems supporting OAuth 2.0 authentication and authorisation, Open Banking, payment initiation and secure financial data access.
- Delivered AI capabilities and multi-tenant SaaS products from concept to production.
- Built Open Banking and payment products used by more than 1.6 million UK consumers, including one of the UK's first white-labelled Open Banking payment widgets.
- Worked with founders, VC investors, enterprise customers and distributed teams across the UK, US, EU and Middle East to shape product and engineering direction.

Experience

Zumi (DVx Ventures)

Mar 2024 - Jul 2026

Head of Engineering

- Joined as employee #1 and built the engineering function, platform architecture and engineering operating model from zero.
- Built and led a 10-person engineering team, with responsibility for hiring, coaching, career development, performance and delivery.
- Worked with founders, enterprise customers and distributed teams across the UK, US and Middle East through multiple company pivots spanning hospitality, payments, AI and data.
- Designed backend services, APIs and multi-tenant SaaS platforms using TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Terraform, Docker and Google Cloud.
- Led production AI development including agents, custom MCP servers, LLM middleware, secure user-scoped API access, request tracking, observability, evaluations and multi-model routing.
- Built integrations with payments, CRM, loyalty, reservations, PMS and POS systems.
- Led multiple products from concept to production, balancing customer needs, technical trade-offs and long-term platform investment.
- Established engineering practices covering architecture, code review, CI/CD, incident response, operational excellence and production reliability.
- Partnered with founders, product leaders, investors and enterprise customers on roadmaps, architecture and technical strategy.

Software Engineer | Solutions Architect | Tech Lead / EM

- Progressed through four engineering leadership roles during a period of rapid company growth.
- Led engineering teams building payments, mobile applications and Open Banking capabilities supporting more than 1.6 million UK consumers.
- Managed engineers across multiple teams, supporting hiring, coaching, technical direction and performance development.
- Designed backend services, APIs and distributed systems supporting OAuth 2.0 authentication and authorisation, payment initiation and secure financial data access.
- Led development of one of the UK's first white-labelled Open Banking payment widgets for major financial institutions.
- Worked with product, compliance, commercial and executive stakeholders to deliver secure, regulated financial products with strong governance and compliance requirements.
- Balanced customer needs, regulatory requirements and long-term technical strategy whilst delivering production systems at scale.

Earlier Experience

Nimble - Software Developer (2018-2020). Built frontend applications, backend services, APIs and integrations for an e-learning platform.

Kappu - Software Developer & Data Protection Officer (2017-2018). First engineering hire. Built the platform alongside the founders whilst establishing engineering processes and delivery practices.

Core Expertise

Engineering Leadership | AI Platforms | AI Agents | MCP | Backend & Platform Engineering | Distributed Systems | OAuth 2.0 | APIs & Enterprise Integrations | Open Banking | Multi-tenant SaaS | TypeScript | PostgreSQL | GCP | Terraform

Education

BSc (Hons) Computing (2:1), FdSc Computing
Canterbury Christ Church University